

PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE –

Notice of Intent to Sole Source

- 1. SOLICITATION NUMBER:** PCA-NIA-00159
- 2. TITLE:** Service and Maintenance of Zeiss LSM 980 and Celldiscoverer 7 Microscope systems
- 3. RESPONSE DATE:** March 31, 2026, at 9 A.M. Eastern Daylight Time (EDT)
- 4. PRIMARY POINT OF CONTACT:**

Nicholas Capobianco
301-496-1318
nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov

I. INTRODUCTION:

THIS IS A PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE (NOTICE OF INTENT) SYNOPSIS TO AWARD A CONTRACT WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME).

The National Institute of Aging (NIA) intends to negotiate and award a purchase order without providing for full and open competition to Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC (Thornwood, NY). The purpose of this requirement is to provide service and maintenance support for the Zeiss LSM 980 and Celldiscoverer 7 microscope systems currently installed at the Center for Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias.

II. NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM (NAICS) CODE and SET ASIDE STATUS

NAICS Code 811210 – Electronic and Precision Equipment Repair and Maintenance - \$34.0 Million SBA Size Standard. This acquisition is NOT set aside for small businesses.

III. REGULATORY AUTHORITY

The resultant contract will include all applicable provisions and clauses in effect through the Federal Acquisition Circular (FAC) 2024-07 dated 08-29-2024.

This acquisition will be conducted using the procedures of FAR Part 13 – Simplified Acquisition Procedures and FAR Part 12 – Acquisition of Commercial Items.

IV. STATUTORY AUTHORITY

This acquisition is being conducted under the authority of FAR 13.106-1(b)(1), Soliciting from a Single Source. The total estimated value of this requirement is below the Simplified Acquisition Threshold.

V. DESCRIPTION OF REQUIREMENT:

A. PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES:

The purpose of this requirement is to provide service and maintenance support for the Zeiss LSM 980 and Celldiscoverer 7 microscope systems currently installed at the Center for Alzheimer's Disease and Related Dementias. The contractor shall provide preventative maintenance, repair services, software updates, and replacement parts necessary to maintain the systems in full operational condition in accordance with the manufacturer's specifications. The contractor shall also provide OEM-certified service technicians capable of troubleshooting and repairing system components.

B. PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE:

Base Year: 05/26/2026 – 05/25/2027

Option Year 1: 05/26/2027 – 05/25/2028

Option Year 2: 05/26/2028 – 05/25/2029

C. PROJECT REQUIREMENTS:

Maintenance and repair support for **Zeiss LSM 980 and Celldiscoverer 7 Microscope systems** shall include all labor, travel, and replacement parts necessary to provide preventative maintenance support, install new instrument software upgrades and train staff in use of the new software, and troubleshoot problems in person and via telephone Monday through Friday from 9AM to 5PM Eastern Time. Replacement parts and software upgrades provided must be Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) certified. Only Original Equipment Manufacturer trained service technicians shall acknowledge repair requests within 24 business hours, and an onsite visit from a technician shall occur within 72 business hours.

VI. CONTRACTING WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME) DETERMINATION

The determination by the Government to award a contract without providing for full and open competition is based upon the market research conducted. Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC is the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) of the Zeiss LSM 980 and Celldiscoverer 7 microscope systems and is the only vendor with access to proprietary diagnostic software, certified replacement parts, and factory calibration procedures required to maintain the systems in accordance with manufacturer specifications. In accordance with FAR part 10, extensive market research was conducted to reach this determination. Additionally, contacts with knowledgeable individuals both in industry and Government, as well as reviews of available product literature, revealed no other sources. Finally, a review of the GSA Advantage, Dynamic Small Business Search, and previous government acquisitions returned no results that meet all of the requirements. Therefore, only Carl Zeiss Microscopy is capable of meeting the needs of this requirement.

The intended source is:

Carl Zeiss Microscopy, LLC

One Zeiss Drive

Thornwood, NY 10594

VII. CLOSING STATEMENT

THIS SYNOPSIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR COMPETITIVE PROPOSALS. However, interested parties may identify their interest and capability to respond to this notice.

A determination by the Government not to compete this proposed contract based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government. All responsible sources may submit a capability statement, proposal, or quotation which shall be considered by the agency. The information received will normally be considered solely for the purposes of determining whether to proceed on a non-competitive basis or to conduct a competitive procurement. This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in response.

Responses to this notice shall contain sufficient information to establish the interested parties' bona-fide capabilities for fulfilling the requirement and include: unit price, list price, shipping and handling costs, the delivery period after contract award, the prompt payment discount terms, the F.O.B. Point (Destination or Origin), the Unique Entity Identifier (UEI), the Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN), and the certification of business size. All offerors must have an active registration in the System for Award Management (SAM) www.sam.gov.

All responses must be received by the closing date and time of this announcement and must reference the solicitation number, **PCA-NIA-00159**. Responses must be submitted electronically to Nicholas Capobianco, Program Specialist, nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov.